

Every date that matters — Fall 2027 entry

All deadlines for the fourteen universities under consideration, consolidated from the program dossiers (researched against official sources Aug 15, 2026). Dates are the published cycle's — re-verify each when applications open in fall 2026.

Sep 28

TARA booking closes (Oxford) — Oxbridge test window Oct 12–16

Oct 15

UCAS (Oxford/Cambridge) + Stanford REA arts track

Nov 1–2

nine early deadlines land together

Dec 1

NEC dual-degree + CMU Music (both with violin prescreen)

May 1

Decision Day — one choice

1 The shape of the year

Five seasons, in order. The heavy lifting is September–December; spring is auditions and decisions.

Aug – Sep 2026 UW & UIUC apps open · UC app drafting · optional SAT EBRW retake · Oxbridge choice + TARA booking by Sep 28	Oct – Nov TARA Oct 12–16 · UCAS Oct 15 · Stanford arts REA Oct 15 · UC files Oct 1–Nov 30 · Nov 1–2 early wave · UW Nov 15 · UC Nov 30	Dec Dec 1: NEC + CMU Music prescreens · Oxbridge online interviews · early decisions mid-Dec · RD essays finalized	Jan – Feb RD wave Jan 1–5 · Oxford Jan 12 / Cambridge Jan 27 decisions · NEC recs Jan 15 · Feb: NEC live audition (Boston) · aid forms	Mar – May Decisions Feb–Apr · aid offers · May 1: commit
--	---	--	--	--

2 The early-round matrix — what can be paired with what

Every early program on the list, its binding/restriction rules, and the three legal game plans. The one family decision (by **Sep 30**): which plan — it cannot be changed after the November filings.

Program (deadline)	Type	Binding?	What it forbids	What it allows alongside
Harvard REA · Yale SCEA · Princeton SCEA (Nov 1) · Stanford REA (Nov 1; arts track Oct 15)	Restrictive early	No — admit can wait until May 1	Every <i>other</i> private early: no MIT EA, no UChicago EA, no ED anywhere	Public EA (UIUC, UW, UCs) · foreign non-binding (Oxbridge UCAS — verify each school's wording) · everything at RD
MIT EA (Nov 1)	Open EA — MIT has no ED	No	Nothing (MIT's side) — but HYPs REA rules bar it from <i>their</i> side	UChicago EA · UIUC EA · publics · Oxbridge · even an ED elsewhere
UChicago EA (Nov 2)	Open EA	No	Nothing — but barred if an REA/SCEA card is played	MIT EA · UIUC EA · publics · Oxbridge
UPenn ED · Cornell ED (Nov 1) · UChicago ED I (Nov 2) — <i>note: Cornell has no EA; its only early door is binding</i>	Early Decision	YES — admit = enroll	An admit ends the season : withdraw every pending application — Harvard RD, Oxbridge, everything	While pending: open EA (MIT, UIUC) + publics + Oxbridge

UIUC EA (Nov 1) • UW (Nov 15) • UCs (Nov 30)	Public / non-restrictive	No	Nothing	Everything — these combine with any plan
Oxford or Cambridge — UCAS (Oct 15)	Foreign, non-binding	No (offer is conditional, not binding)	Only each other (one Oxbridge slot/year)	Generally permitted under REA/SCEA (foreign + non-binding) — verify wording per school ; an ED admit would force withdrawing it

Plan A — one restrictive lottery

THE HARVARD-FIRST STRATEGY

Play	ONE of Harvard REA / Yale SCEA / Princeton SCEA / Stanford REA
Plus	UIUC EA • UW • UCs • Oxbridge UCAS
Give up	MIT EA and UChicago EA move to Jan RD/RA — later answer, same odds; nothing is forfeited
Keeps open	everything — REA admit can still wait to May 1 and compare

Plan B — the early-options spread

MAXIMUM EARLY ANSWERS, NOTHING RESTRICTED

Play	MIT EA + UChicago EA + UIUC EA + UW + UCs + Oxbridge
Give up	no REA/SCEA card — HYPs all wait for RD (still fully available)
Get	up to five answers by late January, all non-binding
Keeps open	Harvard/Yale/Princeton/Stanford at RD — an admit there is still takeable

Plan C — the binding bet

EARLY DECISION • NOT RECOMMENDED FOR THIS PROFILE

Play	UPenn ED / Cornell ED / UChicago ED I (+ open EAs while pending)
Cost	an admit ends everything — Harvard RD and Oxbridge withdrawn unread
Only if	that school outranks Harvard in the family's own ordering
Verdict	conflicts with the stated "take Harvard if it comes" principle

Reading the matrix against the family's stated principles. "ED only for a school we'd happily lock" + "early options that don't preclude Harvard later" resolves cleanly once two rule facts are in: **MIT has no ED** — its early round is open EA, so the "happy lottery" instinct about MIT belongs in **Plan B**, not in an ED; and **Cornell has no EA** — its only early door is binding ED, so Cornell-as-a-non-committal-early-option doesn't exist (Cornell RD keeps it alive instead). Since any ED admit forecloses a later Harvard, **Plan C is structurally wrong for this family** — the real September 30 decision is **A versus B**: one restrictive HYPs lottery with public backups, or five non-binding early answers with HYPs at RD. Oxbridge and the publics ride along with either. (Restriction rules are each school's own policy fine print — re-verify the REA/SCEA wording, especially its foreign-university clause, before filing.)

3 What's in focus — the mental picture, month by month

Each month has one job. Gold ★ rows are personal milestones; the rest are external deadlines. (Items marked "TBD/confirm" need a date or a decision from the family — they can be updated through the admission-book skill.)

August 2026

FOUNDATION — SET THE BOARD

- › **UW application opens Aug 15** — the safety goes first; draft its essays now

★ **SAT plan locked:** register for the fall sittings needed for the EBRW retake (target 750+)

★ **Audition repertoire in daily rotation:** Bach Partita No. 3 (Preludio + Gavotte en Rondeau), Prokofiev concerto mvt, Paganini caprice, Wieniawski / Sarasate *Zigeunerweisen*

★ **ED/REA deliberation opens:** gather the one-early-card facts (see planning notes)

September 2026

OPENINGS — DECIDE AND DRAFT

- › **UIUC opens Sep 1** (CS + Philosophy must be first-choice major)

★ **Oxbridge choice by ~Sep 10** — Oxford (PPL) or Cambridge (PBS): one slot, and it sets the test plan

- › **TARA booked by Sep 28, 6pm UK** — required for Oxford PPL; UAT-UK window open now; the test sits **Oct 12–16** (*resolves the former "TARA date TBD"*)

★ **SAT sitting (if taken)** — safest last chance for the early round; check College Board registration deadlines

★ **ED/REA choice made by Sep 30** — it dictates October's workload

★ **Audition recording session 1** — first full takes of all four works

- › Common App + UC PIQ essay drafts complete

October 2026

COMMIT MONTH — RECORD AND FILE EARLY

- › **Oct 1:** UC filing window opens · CSS Profile & FAFSA open

- › **Oct 12–16: TARA test** (if Oxford) · **Oct 15, 6pm UK: UCAS deadline** — the Oxbridge application files

- › **Oct 22:** My Cambridge Application + transcript + £60 (if Cambridge)

- › **Oct 15 / Oct 20:** Stanford REA *with arts portfolio* — only if Stanford is the early card

★ **Last SAT chance for REA/SCEA schools — the October sitting** (Harvard accepts early-Nov; MIT EA through Nov 30)

★ **Audition recording FINAL takes** — the master video set must exist by Oct 31; it feeds every portfolio and both Dec 1 prescreens

- › Teacher/counselor recommendations confirmed in the portals

November 2026

THE WAVE — SUBMIT EVERYTHING EARLY

- › **Nov 1–2:** the early application (chosen card) + UIUC EA + any non-restricted publics

- › **Nov 6 / Nov 8:** Princeton / Yale early arts supplements (from the master video)

- › **Nov 15:** UW deadline · early aid forms (Stanford/UChicago/Cornell/CMU)

- › **Nov 30:** UC application closes · MIT EA last test date + aid forms

★ **RD essays drafted before Thanksgiving** — December belongs to music

December 2026

MUSIC MONTH — AND EVERYTHING FINISHED

- › **Dec 1: NEC prescreen + CMU Music application/prescreen** — both from the October master video
- › **Dec 1 (optional): Yale YSM B.A./M.M. application + prescreen** — only if the pre-matriculation route is chosen; needs the Mozart movement (see repertoire map)
- › **Oxbridge interviews, online** — Cambridge Dec 7–18; Oxford through December
- › **Dec 5 / Dec 10: Stanford RD with arts portfolio** — the early-RD music track
- ★ **December SAT** — final chance that reaches RD readers (and MIT RA, scores by Feb 15)
- › **Mid-Dec:** early decision arrives — defer/deny means the RD wave goes out as planned
- ★ **Dec 31 house rule: every remaining application submitted** — nothing left for January deadlines

January 2027

FOLLOW-THROUGH — SUPPLEMENTS AND RECS

- › **Jan 1–5:** RD deadlines pass (already submitted per the Dec 31 rule)
- › **Jan 12 / Jan 27:** Oxford / Cambridge decisions via UCAS
- › **Jan 8 / Jan 9:** Princeton / Yale RD arts supplements
- › **Jan 15:** NEC recommendations & transcripts · UChicago ED II aid
- › **Jan 10:** Berkeley invited letters (if invited)
- ★ **February audition prep begins:** NEC live adds étude/caprice + piano sonata (or Mozart) + the personally meaningful piece

February

- ★ **NEC live audition, Boston**
- ★ **Yale YSM live audition, New Haven — Feb 22–28** (only if Dec 1 route taken & prescreen passed)
- ★ **CMU live audition** (Pittsburgh/NYC)
- › RD aid forms (Feb 1 / Feb 15)

March

- › UW decisions Mar 1–15
- › Late-March decision wave + NEC
- › Berkeley aid due Mar 2

April

- › Stanford / Penn / CMU decisions
- ★ **Compare aid offers; visit if possible**

May 2027

- › **May 1: Decision Day** — one deposit
- ★ **AP exams:** Calc BC · Physics 1 · CS A · English Lit · Statistics/Psychology

The recording repertoire → what each piece unlocks. The four works cover nearly every requirement:

Work	Satisfies
Bach Partita No. 3 in E major — Preludio + Gavotte en Rondeau	NEC prescreen's <i>two contrasting Bach movements</i> ✓ · CMU's Bach movement ✓ · Bach anchor for Stanford/Princeton/MIT/Yale/Cornell portfolios ✓ · Yale YSM prescreen's <i>one unaccompanied Bach movement</i> ✓
Prokofiev Violin Concerto (1st mvt / exposition)	NEC's major concerto 1800–1945 ✓ · CMU's non-Baroque concerto Allegro ✓ · the "big" portfolio piece ✓ · Yale YSM's <i>Classical/Romantic/20th-c. concerto movement</i> ✓
Paganini Caprice (<i>listed as "No. 25" — the 24 Caprices end at No. 24; confirm which is meant, e.g. No. 24</i>)	CMU's étude/caprice (memorized) ✓ · NEC live-audition étude slot (Paganini Op. 1 qualifies) ✓ · Yale YSM's <i>any Paganini caprice</i> ✓
Wieniawski / Sarasate Zigeunerweisen	NEC's "personally meaningful piece" ✓ · the short contrasting showpiece for the ~10-min portfolios ✓ · Yale YSM's <i>short standalone piece (any style)</i> ✓

Still uncovered: NEC's live-audition sonata/Mozart slot — and, if the optional **Yale YSM Dec 1 route** is taken, the **first movement of a Mozart concerto with cadenza**, the one YSM prescreen item the four works don't supply. One Mozart movement prepared by late November covers both. Otherwise the Yale B.A./M.M. audition waits (same repertoire list) until junior year at Yale.

4 Month-by-month master checklist

Every dated obligation, in the order it arrives. Music-related items are shaded gold. Color bar = school (named on every line).

September 2026

- Sep 1 | UIUC application opens
- Sep (mid) | All schools — confirm 2026–27 dates as sites update
- ~Sep 10 | Oxbridge — family picks Oxford or Cambridge (one slot per year)
- Sep 28 | Oxford TARA booking closes 6pm UK (UAT-UK; needed for PPL)
- Sep | Violin — record prescreen/arts-supplement footage early
MUSIC

October 2026

- Oct 1 | UC Berkeley filing window opens (through Nov 30)
- Oct 1 | Aid — CSS Profile & FAFSA open
- Oct 12–16 | Oxford TARA test window (Pearson centre)
- Oct 15 | Oxford / Cambridge — UCAS application closes 6pm UK
- Oct 22 | Cambridge My Cambridge Application + transcript + £60
- Oct 15 | Stanford REA with arts portfolio: application due MUSIC
- Oct 20 | Stanford REA portfolio materials due MUSIC
- Oct 31 | Stanford REA: last SAT sitting (ACT: end of Sep)

November 2026

- Nov 1 | Harvard REA + aid forms (CSS/FAFSA/IDOC)
- Nov 1 | Yale SCEA
- Nov 1 | Princeton SCEA
- Nov 1 | Stanford REA (no-portfolio track)
- Nov 1 | MIT EA (own portal)
- Nov 1 | UPenn ED (binding)
- Nov 1 | Cornell ED (binding; materials Nov 13)
- Nov 1 | UIUC Early Action (materials Nov 7)
- Nov 2 | UChicago EA / ED I
- Nov 6 | Princeton SCEA arts supplement
MUSIC
- Nov 8 | Yale SCEA music supplement
MUSIC
- Nov 15 | UW single application deadline
- Nov 15 | Aid — Stanford REA · UChicago EA/ED I · CMU ED · Cornell ED forms
- Nov 30 | UC Berkeley application closes
- Nov 30 | MIT EA: last SAT/ACT date · aid forms due

December 2026

- Dec 1 | **Harvard-NEC** dual degree: NEC application + prescreen video **MUSIC**
- Dec 1 | **CMU School of Music** application + violin prescreen (Acceptd); no ED for Music **MUSIC**
- Dec 5 | **Stanford RD with arts portfolio**: application due (materials Dec 10) **MUSIC**
- Dec 1 | **Yale YSM B.A./M.M.** application + prescreen — *optional pre-matriculation route* **MUSIC**
- Dec 7–18 | **Cambridge** interviews (online for internationals)
- Dec | **Oxford** interviews (online, Microsoft Teams)
- Mid-Dec | **Early decisions** — Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Stanford, MIT, UPenn, Cornell, UChicago
- Dec 31 | **MIT RA**: last SAT/ACT date (scores by Feb 15)

January 2027

- Jan 12 | **Oxford** decision via UCAS
- Jan 27 | **Cambridge** decision (winter pool mid-late Jan)
- Jan 1 | **Harvard** RD
- Jan 1 | **Princeton** RD
- Jan 2 | **Yale** RD
- Jan 2 | **Cornell** RD (materials Jan 19)
- Jan 4 | **MIT** Regular Action
- Jan 4 | **UChicago** ED II / RD
- Jan 4 | **CMU** RD (non-Music colleges)
- Jan 5 | **Stanford** RD
- Jan 5 | **UPenn** RD
- Jan 5 | **UIUC** regular deadline (materials Jan 11)
- Jan 8 | **Princeton** RD arts supplement **MUSIC**
- Jan 9 | **Yale** RD music supplement **MUSIC**
- Jan 10 | **UC Berkeley** optional invited letters due
- Jan 15 | **NEC** recommendations & transcripts **MUSIC**
- Jan 15 | **UChicago** ED II aid forms
- ~Jan 30 | **UIUC** EA decisions (CS+X may defer to March)

February 2027

- Feb 1 | **Aid** — Harvard & UPenn RD forms · UW priority date
- Feb | **NEC live audition, Boston** (prescreen passers; higher-than-B.M. standard) **MUSIC**
- Feb | **CMU Music** live audition (dates TBA; Pittsburgh + NYC regionals) **MUSIC**
- Feb 22–28 | **Yale YSM** live audition, New Haven — attendance required (if Dec 1 route + prescreen passed) **MUSIC**
- Feb 15 | **Aid** — Stanford, MIT, CMU, Cornell, UChicago RD forms · NEC aid priority
- Mid-Feb | **UChicago** ED II decisions
- Feb 28 | **UW** Husky Promise FAFSA/WASFA date (WA residents)

March 2027

- Mar 1–15 | **UW** decisions
- Mar 2 | **UC Berkeley** FAFSA/CADAA deadline
- ~Mar 6 | **UIUC** regular decisions
- Mid-Mar | **MIT** RA decisions
- Late Mar | **RD decisions** — Harvard, Yale, Princeton, Cornell, UChicago, Berkeley
- Late Mar | **NEC** dual-degree decision **MUSIC**
- ~Mar 15 | **UIUC** FAFSA priority date

April 2027

- Early Apr | **Stanford** RD decisions
- Apr | **UPenn** RD decisions
- By Apr 1 | **CMU** decisions (incl. School of Music)
- Apr | **Compare aid offers** — appeal windows are short

May 2027

- May 1 | **National Decision Day** — deposit at ONE school (UC SIR also due May 1)

5 School-by-school card file

The same dates, filed per school — for pinning next to each application.

Stanford

COMMON APP • \$100 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

REA (arts track) **Oct 15 / Oct 20**

REA standard **Nov 1**

RD (arts track) **Dec 5 / Dec 10**

RD standard **Jan 5**

Aid (REA / RD) **Nov 15 / Feb 15**

Decisions **mid-Dec / early Apr**

Princeton

COMMON APP • TEST-OPTIONAL (FINAL YEAR)

SCEA **Nov 1**

Arts supp (SCEA/RD) **Nov 6 / Jan 8**

RD **Jan 1**

Decisions **mid-Dec / late Mar**

Harvard (+ NEC)

COMMON APP • \$90 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

REA + aid forms **Nov 1**

NEC app + prescreen **Dec 1**

RD **Jan 1**

NEC recs **Jan 15**

NEC live audition **February**

Decisions (both) **mid-Dec / late Mar**

Yale

COMMON APP • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

SCEA **Nov 1**

Music supp
(SCEA/RD) **Nov 8 / Jan 9**

RD **Jan 2**

Decisions **mid-Dec / late Mar**

B.A./M.M. (YSM) **optional now: YSM app
Dec 1 + live audition Feb
22-28 (New Haven) — or
defer to 3rd year; M.M. is
tuition-free**

MIT

MIT PORTAL • \$75 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

EA **Nov 1**

Last test (EA / RA) **Nov 30 / Dec 31**

Aid (EA / RA) **Nov 30 / Feb 15**

RA **Jan 4**

Decisions **mid-Dec / mid-Mar**

UChicago

COMMON APP • TEST-OPTIONAL • NO CSS

EA / ED I **Nov 2**

ED II / RD **Jan 4**

Aid (EA / EDII / RD) **Nov 15 / Jan 15 / Feb 15**

Decisions **mid-Dec / mid-Feb / late
Mar**

CMU

COMMON APP • \$75 • CFA TEST-OPTIONAL

Music app +
prescreen **Dec 1**

ED (non-Music) **Nov 2**

RD (non-Music) **Jan 4**

Live audition **Feb (TBA)**

Decisions **by Apr 1**

UPenn

COMMON APP • \$75 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

ED (binding) **Nov 1**

Last SAT (ED / RD) **Nov 7 / Dec 5**

Aid (ED / RD) **Nov 6 / Feb 1**

RD **Jan 5**

Decisions **Dec / Apr**

Cornell

COMMON APP • \$85 • SAT/ACT REQUIRED

ED (binding) **Nov 1 (materials Nov 13)**

RD **Jan 2 (materials Jan 19)**

Aid (ED / RD) **~Nov 15 / ~Feb 15**

Decisions **mid-Dec / late Mar**

UC Berkeley

UC APP ONLY • \$80 • TEST-BLIND

Filing window **Oct 1 – Nov 30**

Invited letters **Jan 10**

Aid (FAFSA/CADAA) **Mar 2**

Decisions / SIR **end Mar / May 1**

UIUC

MYILLINOIS OR COMMON APP • TEST-
OPTIONAL

App opens **Sep 1**

EA **Nov 1 (materials Nov 7)**

Regular **Jan 5 (materials Jan 11)**

Decisions (EA / RD) **~Jan 30 / ~Mar 6**

FAFSA priority **~Mar 15**

UW-Seattle

COMMON APP • \$85 • TEST-FREE

Opens / closes **Aug 15 / Nov 15**

Aid priority **Feb 1 (Husky Promise Feb
28)**

Decisions **Mar 1-15**

Music **no audition at admission;
ensembles audition Sep
after enrolling**

Oxford (if chosen — one Oxbridge slot)

UCAS · PPL (PSYCHOLOGY, PHILOSOPHY & LINGUISTICS) · TARA REQUIRED

TARA booking	by Sep 28, 6pm UK
UCAS deadline	Oct 15, 6pm UK
TARA test	Oct 12–16
Interviews	Dec (online, Teams)
Decision	Jan 12
Money	no US need-based aid; ~£55k/yr fees (PPL, 2026/27) + living; US federal loans only

Cambridge (if chosen — one Oxbridge slot)

UCAS · PBS (PSYCHOLOGICAL & BEHAVIOURAL SCIENCES) · NO PRE-REGISTERED TEST

UCAS deadline	Oct 15, 6pm UK
My Cambridge App	Oct 22 (+ transcript, £60)
Assessment	at interview (college-set)
Interviews	Dec 7–18 (online)
Decision	Jan 27 (pool mid-late Jan)
Money	no int'l need grants; PBS £44k vs HSPS/Law £29k (2026/27); 3-yr degree; US federal loans

6 Violin — portfolio & audition repertoire, stage by stage

Every program that can receive the violin work, what each stage requires, and when it's due. Verified against the official audition/portfolio pages Aug 15, 2026.

NEC — Harvard dual degree

REQUIRED · JUDGED ABOVE B.M. STANDARD · NECMUSIC.EDU/AUDITIONS/VIOLIN

Prescreen video due Dec 1	① Exposition (or first 5 min) of the 1st mvt of a major concerto, 1800–1945 (Shostakovich No. 1: 4th mvt/cadenza allowed) · ② Two contrasting movements of an unaccompanied Bach sonata/partita . Single unedited takes, one file per piece.
Live audition February, Boston (memorized)	① Concerto 1st mvt (1800–1945) · ② two contrasting Bach mvts (may reuse prescreen) · ③ étude/caprice from Rode Op. 22, Dont Op. 35, Wieniawski Op. 10/18, or Paganini Op. 1 · ④ sonata 1st mvt with piano in a contrasting style — or Mozart concerto exposition (Mozart <i>required</i> if unaccompanied) · ⑤ one personally meaningful piece of her choosing.
Recorded alternative	15-minute single continuous unedited take , memorized; ≥3 selections incl. concerto exposition + one Bach mvt + own choice.

CMU School of Music (BXA)

REQUIRED · ALL REPERTOIRE FROM MEMORY · VIA ACCEPTD

Prescreen video due Dec 1	① One étude (Kreutzer, Fiorillo, Rode, Dont, Gaviniès) or a caprice (Wieniawski, Paganini) · ② Allegro movement of a non-Baroque concerto · ③ one movement of a Bach solo sonata/partita .
Live audition Feb (TBA); Pittsburgh or NYC	Same repertoire as the prescreen; unaccompanied.

Stanford — Arts Portfolio (Music)

OPTIONAL · VIDEO ONLY · MOVES THE WHOLE APP EARLIER

Due (REA)	app Oct 15 · media Oct 20
Due (RD)	app Dec 5 · media Dec 10
Content	2–3 short contrasting pieces, ~10 min total; videos no older than one year; accompaniment optional (no disadvantage without). Music résumé; a teacher recommendation encouraged.

Princeton — Arts Supplement (Music)

OPTIONAL · REVIEWED BY MUSIC FACULTY

Due (SCEA / RD)	Nov 6 / Jan 8
Content	10–15 min of advanced solo work showing contrasting expression and technique (no ensemble unless prominently soloed). Audio or video (or YouTube/Vimeo/SoundCloud). Plus music résumé and a 250-word statement on integrating music at Princeton.

MIT — Creative Portfolio (Music)

OPTIONAL · SLIDEROOM · \$10 (WAIVABLE ≥3 DAYS PRE-DEADLINE)

Due	with the application (Nov 1 EA / Jan 4 RA)
Content	Two recordings of contrasting styles/periods, 10 min combined; unedited solo performances, accompaniment as feasible. Performing-arts résumé + one music-teacher recommendation requested through SlideRoom. Reviewed by Music & Theater Arts faculty.

Yale — Music Supplement + B.A./M.M. (YSM) · Cornell — Recording

SUPPLEMENT OPTIONAL · YSM AUDITION = GRADUATE-CONSERVATORY STANDARD · MUSIC.YALE.EDU/HOW-APPLY

Yale supplement (SCEA / RD)	Nov 8 / Jan 9 via the status portal; 2–3 contrasting pieces, reviewed by Yale music faculty. Submit only if it shows "a high level of ability". <i>Separate from the B.A./M.M. audition.</i>
Yale B.A./M.M. — YSM prescreen Dec 1 (optional pre-matriculation route; or same list in junior year at Yale)	① one movement of unaccompanied Bach sonata/partita · ② first movement of a Mozart concerto, with cadenza · ③ any Paganini caprice · ④ one movement of a Classical (non-Mozart)/Romantic/20th-c. concerto · ⑤ a short standalone piece, any style (not a sonata/concerto movement). \$150 fee (waived with Yale College fee waiver). <i>Fall 2026-cycle list; 2027 cycle posts Sep 15, 2026.</i>
YSM live audition Feb 22–28, 2027; New Haven	Attendance required, in person. Same repertoire guidelines; M.M. applicants are <i>not</i> asked for Mozart live. Prescreen results by end of January; decisions by Apr 1–15. The M.M. year is tuition-free with a stipend .
Cornell (ED / RD)	Arts & Sciences accepts a musical recording as its only supplemental material — submit with the Nov 1 / Jan 2 application per A&S instructions.
No music at admission	UChicago (2-min video is general, not musical), UPenn, UC Berkeley, UIUC, UW — ensembles audition <i>after</i> enrollment. Oxford & Cambridge ignore music at admission; college awards/IAS audition after arrival.

One recording session can feed almost everything. A single well-produced October session covering ① a movement of solo Bach, ② the first movement (or exposition) of a Romantic-era concerto, and ③ a short contrasting piece satisfies Stanford, Princeton, MIT, Yale, and Cornell outright and supplies both required prescreens (NEC needs a *second* contrasting Bach movement; CMU needs the memorized étude/caprice — the

only item on no other list). Record in one block, then trim per school. The live-audition-only additions (NEC's piano sonata/Mozart + meaningful piece) can be prepared over winter break for February.

Three planning notes. ① **Only one early card can be played** (full pairing rules + the three legal game plans: section ②) among Harvard REA, Yale SCEA, Princeton SCEA, Stanford REA, UPenn ED, Cornell ED, and UChicago ED I — the restrictive/binding programs exclude each other (MIT EA is non-restrictive but is barred *by the other schools'* REA/SCEA rules; UIUC EA, UW, and the UCs are public/non-binding and combine freely with any of them). ② An **SAT EBRW retake** aimed at 750+ must land by the October sitting for REA/SCEA schools — August or September is safer. ③ **Dec 1 is the quiet killer:** the NEC prescreen video and CMU violin prescreen both come due four weeks after the Nov 1 wave — the recording should exist by October, not be scheduled for Thanksgiving.

Repertoire verified Aug 15, 2026 against NEC's violin audition page, CMU's violin requirements page, Stanford Music's recorded-arts-portfolio page, Princeton's optional-arts-supplement page, MIT's creative-portfolios page, and Yale's supplementary-materials page. NEC dual-degree candidates are auditioned to a higher standard than regular B.M. applicants; the published B.M. repertoire is the base requirement. Dates consolidated from the twelve program dossiers (ai-kitchen-inc/university-admission-research · brochures/), each researched against official admissions, program, and aid pages on August 15, 2026. Where a school had not yet posted its 2026–27 calendar, the current published cycle's dates are shown — re-verify each on the official page when applications open. UChicago's Nov 2 early deadline reflects its published page (Nov 1, 2026 is a Sunday); confirm in-cycle. Decision months marked "~" are the school's typical release window, not a guaranteed date. Oxbridge dates (TARA/UCAS/interviews/decisions) and the Yale YSM B.A./M.M. repertoire and audition dates verified Aug 16, 2026 against Oxford's 2027-entry pages, Cambridge's 2027-entry pages, and music.yale.edu (YSM list shown is the Fall 2026 cycle; the Fall 2027 cycle posts Sep 15, 2026 — re-verify then).